

Question:

A 45-year-old woman comes to the physician because of a 5-kg (11-lb) weight loss and difficulty swallowing. She is able to swallow liquids without difficulty but feels like solid foods get stuck in her throat. Physical examination shows taut skin and limited range of motion of the fingers. There are telangiectasias over the cheeks. An esophageal motility study shows absence of peristalsis in the lower two-thirds of the esophagus and decreased lower esophageal sphincter pressure. Further evaluation of this patient is most likely to show which of the following? Answer Choices: A. Amyloid deposits in the liver B. Budding yeasts on the oral mucosa C. Parasite nests in the myocardium D. Arteriolar wall thickening in the kidney

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>the lower esophageal sphincter regulates what gets into the stomach</think><answer>arteriolar wall thickening in the kidney</answer>

